Like a breath of Dante’s hell
As befits a prison cell.
And while others cast their ballots,
Partied, danced—we sat on pallets,
Vainly guessing (what a chore!)
How much more we had in store
Isolations, deprivations,
And what for?
Then a warder scurried up,
Threatened, lied to shut us up,
But by our calculation
Right across your mighty nation
States like Kansas, Illinois,
Gave us cause for lots of joy.
By “lights out” it was quite clear
You had nothing left to fear.
So we hunkered down to sleep
By the heater (minus heat)
Chilly drafts crept round the cell
And we sighed: We wish you well
Mister President,
The White House,
Coast to coast the USA
And those there, who’re still awake
We’re not sleeping, just like you,
All in goose-bumps, cold and blue,
Our teeth chattering in sorrow:
“Great October” day tomorrow!

What manner of government, I asked myself, stifled a people’s yearnings for freedom by making them prisoners?

During December, I held a series of meetings with the small group within the NSPG that I had delegated to help me in developing strategy for our new talks with the Russians.

Cap, a strong booster of the SDI, said the Russians were almost certainly going to demand that we kill it as the price